

Μοδεράτος ὁ Γαδειτανός

Moderatus of Gades on Pythagorean Number Theory

eul_aid: noi

Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#) (phi, frg)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Pythagorean](#)

Moderatus of Gades was a first-century CE philosopher active in the Roman Empire. He was a Neopythagorean, part of a movement that revived and reinterpreted the teachings of Pythagoras. He originated from Gades, modern Cádiz in Spain, a major port in the Roman province of Hispania. Beyond this, the specific details of his life and education are unknown.

His importance rests on a single, lost work, often referred to as Pythagorean Lectures or Pythagorean Doctrines. This book survives only in fragments quoted centuries later by Neoplatonist philosophers such as Porphyry and Simplicius. These fragments show that Moderatus worked to systematize Pythagorean ideas, often blending them with concepts from Plato and Aristotle.

According to scholars, his main contribution was a metaphysical system that used numbers and principles to explain how a supreme, ineffable reality connects to the physical world. This framework is seen as an important step between early Pythagorean thought and the later emanation theories of Neoplatonism. He was also cited as an authority on the symbolic and mysterious sayings of the Pythagoreans. In this way, Moderatus served as a key bridge, preserving and transforming Pythagorean philosophy for later generations in the Roman world.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα · [On Pythagorean Number Theory](#) · 3 passages

Other Pythagorean Authors

- Ἀπολλόδωρος ὁ Κυζικηνός · [Apollodorus of Cyzicus](#) · 1 work
- Ἀπολλώνιος ὁ Τυανεύς · [Apollonius of Tyana](#) · 3 works
- Ἀπολλώνιος ὁ Τυανεύς · [Apollonius of Tyana II](#) · 1 work
- Ἀρχύτας ὁ Ταραντῖνος · [Archytas of Tarentum](#) · 2 works
- Ἀρέσας ὁ Λευκανός · [Aresas of Lucania](#) · 1 work
- Ἀθάμας ὁ Ποσειδωνιάτης · [Athamas of Posidonia](#) · 1 work
- Βροντῖνος ὁ Μεταποντῖνος · [Brontinus of Metapontum](#) · 2 works
- Κέρκωψ ὁ Ὀρφικός · [Cercops the Orphic](#) · 1 work
- Κλεινίας ὁ Ταραντῖνος · [Clinias of Tarentum](#) · 2 works

- Δάμων καὶ Φιντίας · Damon and Phintias · 1 work
- Ἐχεκράτης ὁ Φλιάσιος · Echecrates of Phlius · 1 work
- Ἐκφάντος ὁ Πυθαγόρειος · Ecphantus the Pythagorean · 2 works